

POWERED BY NEX-GEN

Lumina Homeowner Guide

Everything you need to run your permanent outdoor lighting — plus troubleshooting and answers to the questions we hear most.

Welcome to Lumina. Your lights are installed, tuned, and already talking to the app. This guide covers the parts you'll use every day first, then the "why is it doing that?" moments at the end.

Read Sections 1–5 and you're 90% of the way there. Everything after that is a feature to pick up whenever you're curious.

What you'll need

- The **Lumina** app on your phone or tablet (App Store / Google Play)
- The **email and temporary password** your installer gave you
- Your **home Wi-Fi** — the same network your controller is on
- About 10 minutes

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1. Signing in for the first time

Your Lumina account was created for you at install time.

1. Open the **Lumina** app.
2. Enter the **email** and **temporary password** from your installer.
3. Tap **ENTER LUMINA**.
4. You'll be asked to **set a new password** (at least 8 characters). One-time security step.
5. The app loads your home, your lights, and anything your installer set up for you.

If your installer configured a starting look and schedule, you'll see a short welcome screen confirming your lights are ready, with the option to let **Auto-Pilot** take over your lighting plan. Say yes now or turn it on later — Section 9.

Didn't get credentials? Tap **Forgot Password?** on the sign-in screen and enter your email — or call your installer, who can resend your account details.

Permissions the app asks for

Only two, and only when they're actually needed:

- **Location** — powers *Welcome Home* and lets the app recognize your home Wi-Fi network for remote access. You can tap **Skip for Now** and enable it later.
- **Notifications** — game alerts and schedule reminders.

Neither is required to control your lights.

Taking the tour

The first time you reach the Home screen, a short guided tour appears. Replay it any time from **System** → **Take the Tour**.

2. A quick map of the app

Five buttons live in the glass dock at the bottom of the screen:

Tab	What lives there
Home	Your house photo, power, brightness, favorites, tonight's schedule
Schedule	Your weekly plan — on/off times, patterns, Autopilot
Lumina (center)	Your AI assistant. Tap to chat, press and hold to speak
Explore	The design library — holidays, teams, seasons, whites, and more
System	Settings, controllers, users, remote access, support

At the top of the Home screen:

- **Hello, [your name]** — your greeting
- A **router icon** — cyan means your controller is online, grey means it isn't. Tap it to switch controllers if you have more than one
- A **gear icon** — jumps to Settings

Tapping the tab you're already on returns you to the top of that section. Handy when you've browsed deep into the design library.

3. Your Home screen, part by part

The house photo

The big card at the top is your home. When the lights are on, Lumina animates the current colors and effect right on the roofline of the photo, so you can see what's playing without walking outside.

No photo yet? Tap **Add Your Home** in the corner of the card and pick a picture of your house. You can also do this later in **System** → **My Profile** → **Edit Profile**.

The sky in the photo shifts through the day — dawn, daylight, dusk, night — so the preview matches what you'd actually see outside right now.

The Now Playing bar

The frosted bar across the bottom of the photo is your main control strip:

- **NOW PLAYING** shows the design currently running. When the lights are off it reads **Lights Off**.
- A badge like **2/4 CH** appears when you've filtered to specific zones (Section 4).
- The **tune icon** opens the *Adjust Pattern* panel.
- The **power circle** turns everything on or off.
- The **brightness slider** runs along the bottom.

If a small bookmark icon sits next to the design name, you've tweaked something that isn't saved yet. Tap the name to save it to **My Designs**.

Everything below the photo

- **Design Studio** and **Neighborhood Sync** — two feature buttons
- **Game Day** and **My Designs** — your teams and your saved creations
- **Lumina Suggestions** — timely ideas based on the date, season, and what you've used before. Tap **Apply** to try one
- **My Favorites** — one tap applies a favorite instantly
- **Smart Presets** — quick looks prepared for your system
- **TONIGHT / TODAY** — the next scheduled event. Tap it to edit that schedule

Status messages you might see

What you see	What it means
Syncing...	The app is refreshing from the controller. Normal.
Last Known State	The app can't reach the controller right now and is showing the last thing it knew.
We can't find your lights — check your WiFi connection	No controller is registered or reachable. Tap Retry , or Set Up Controller for a brand-new system.

4. Everyday controls — power, brightness, and zones

Turning the lights on and off

Tap the **power circle** in the Now Playing bar. Your lights return to the last design at the last brightness.

Brightness

Drag the **brightness slider**. Changes apply live — slide until it looks right from the street.

Brightness and design are separate. Turning the lights off and back on keeps the same design; it doesn't reset to white.

Zones and channels

Most homes are wired in several runs — front eave, garage, back fascia, and so on. Lumina calls these **channels**, or **zones** if your installer named them.

To work with one area at a time:

1. Tap the **tune icon** in the Now Playing bar to open **Adjust Pattern**.
2. Scroll to the channel bar. It reads **All Zones** by default.
3. Tap it to expand, then tap a zone name to select just that zone. The header changes to **2 of 4 Zones** and a **FILTERED** badge appears.
4. Any color, pattern, or brightness change now applies **only to the zones you selected**.
5. Tap **All Zones** (or **All**) to go back to controlling everything together.

Each zone chip also has a small **power icon**. Tap it to turn that one run on or off — perfect for lighting just the front of the house.

If part of your house is dark and you can't get it back: open the channel bar and tap **All Channels On**. That re-selects every zone *and* powers each one on. This is the fix for "I turned off the back, and now color changes only affect the front."

The Adjust Pattern panel

The same panel gives you live control over what's playing:

- **Speed** — how fast the effect moves

- **Intensity** — how dense or dramatic the effect is
- **Colors** — tap a swatch to change any color in the current design
- **Save As Custom Pattern** — keeps your tweaked version in **My Designs**

5. Finding a design you love

Tap **Explore**. Three ways in:

1. Just search. Type "Christmas", "Chiefs", "purple", "Halloween". If nothing matches, Lumina offers to either **describe it to Lumina** or **build it in Design Studio** — you're never left at a dead end.

2. Browse the Design Library. Categories include:

- **Holidays** — Christmas, Halloween, Easter, July 4th, and more
- **Game Day Fan Zone** — pro and college teams by league
- **Seasonal Vibes** — Autumn Harvest, Spring Pastels, Summer Vibrance, Winter Frost
- **Parties & Events** — Birthday Brights, Elegant Dinner, Baby Shower, Rave / Strobe
- **Architectural Downlighting (White)** — Warm Whites, Cool Whites, Gold Accents, brightness gradients
- **Security & Alerts** — Security Bright, Alert Red, Police Lights, Caution Amber
- **Movies & Superheroes**
- **Nature & Outdoors** — Galaxy & Starlight, Twinkling Stars
- **My Designs** — everything you've saved

3. Tap a color theme or pre-built pattern on the Explore home screen for the fastest route.

Applying a design

Once you pick a theme — your team, a holiday — you land on the design screen where you choose how it plays:

1. **Colors** — the theme's colors, your own **My Colors**, a **Blended** mix, or **Auto Colors**
2. **Effect** — solid, twinkle, chase, fade, fireworks, and dozens more
3. **LEDs per color** — how wide each color band is
4. **Speed** and **Intensity**
5. **Brightness Pattern** (optional) — a taper such as *Gentle Fade*, *Staircase*, or *Soft Pulse* for a downlighting look
6. Tap **Apply**

Your lights change within a second or two, the Now Playing bar updates, and that design runs until you change it or a schedule takes over.

Found a keeper? Tap the heart to add it to **My Favorites** so it's one tap from the Home screen.

6. Making it yours — adjusting, saving, designing

Design Studio

Home → **Design Studio** is where you create instead of browse.

1. Type what you want in plain English: *"Red and green with white accents on the peaks"* or *"Warm white glow on the entire roofline."*
2. Tap **Create Design**.
3. Leave **Preview on lights: ON** to watch it appear outside as you refine.
4. Not quite right? Describe the change and generate again, or open **Manual controls** to place colors yourself.
5. Tap **Apply to Lights** when you're happy, and save it so it's there next time.

Quick Ideas on that screen give you one-tap starting points: Warm White, Team Colors, Holiday, Downlighting, Chase Effect.

Design Studio is at its best when your **roofline setup** is complete — that's what tells the app where your peaks, corners, and runs are. Your installer normally does this. Review it under **System** → **System Management** → **Roofline Setup**.

My Designs and My Favorites

- **My Designs** holds everything you've created or saved. Reach it from the Home screen or Explore.
- **My Favorites** is your shortlist — the grid right on the Home screen.

Any design you save works everywhere else: schedule it, hand it to Lumina, or use it for Game Day.

Lumina Studio — a pro design for the rest of the yard

Want lighting beyond the roofline? **System** → **Lumina Studio** sends a quote request to a Nex-Gen design specialist.

1. Choose the area: **Landscape**, **Patio**, **Deck**, or **Pool**
2. Add a photo — camera or gallery
3. Drag virtual fixtures (path lights, bistros, and more) onto the photo where you want them
4. Review and **Request Quote**

7. Talking to Lumina (your AI assistant)

The center button in the dock is Lumina.

- **Tap** it to open a chat.
- **Press and hold** it to speak instead of typing.

Ask for what you want in your own words:

- "Set my lights to Chiefs colors"
- "Make it look like Christmas"
- "Something warm and relaxing"
- "Dim to 40%"
- "Turn on warm white at 7pm and off at midnight on weekdays"

Lumina can apply designs, change brightness, create and edit schedules, and suggest ideas. It also learns your preferences over time, so its suggestions sharpen the more you use it.

Quick-start chips on the chat screen: **Warm white**, **Sunset vibes**, **Party mode**, **Calm & cozy**, **Surprise me**, **Game day**.

Lumina is often the fastest way to build a schedule — just describe the times and the look, and check the result on the Schedule tab.

8. Schedules — set it and forget it

Tap the **Schedule** tab. This is where your lights learn your routine, so you're not reaching for your phone every evening.

Creating a schedule

1. Tap **+**.
2. Set the **Turn On** time — a clock time, or **Sunset**.
3. Set the **Turn Off** time — a clock time, or **Sunrise**.
4. Choose **Repeat Days** — individual days, **Weekdays**, or every day.
5. Choose **What should the lights do?**
 - **Run Pattern** — then **Choose a pattern**
 - **Set Brightness** — a plain on at a set level
 - **Turn Off** — an off-only event
6. Tap **Save Schedule**.

Sending schedules to the controller

Schedules live in two places: in your account, and in the controller itself. That second part is what lets your lights run on time even when your phone is off, away, or dead.

The **Sync** button at the top right pushes them across. It normally happens on its own and the button reads **Synced 5m ago** when it's current. Tap it any time to force it.

Message	Meaning
Schedules synced to controller	Done. Your lights will run on time.
Schedule saved with warnings	Saved, but one part didn't take. Tap Sync again.
Controller not reachable...	You're not on your home Wi-Fi. The schedule is saved and syncs next time you're home.
Schedule sync failed	See <i>Troubleshooting</i> → <i>A schedule didn't run</i> .

Sync from home. Writing schedules into the controller only works on your home Wi-Fi. Build a schedule while you're out and it saves fine — just open the Schedule tab once when you get home

and it syncs itself.

Things worth knowing

- You can have up to **20 recurring schedules**.
- If schedules overlap, an orange banner offers a **Clean Up** tool. Overlapping schedules make lighting unpredictable, so it's worth clearing.
- A schedule's **off** time turns the lights off even if you manually applied something afterward. When that's coming up soon, the app tells you: *"Heads up — your 'Warm White' schedule turns the lights off at 11:00 PM."*
- You can anchor a schedule to **Sunset** or **Sunrise** instead of a clock time — one of each per system. See below.

Editing and deleting

Tap any schedule under **Recurring Schedules** to edit it; **Delete Schedule** is inside the editor. You can also tap the **TONIGHT / TODAY** card on the Home screen to jump straight into the schedule coming up next.

Time format

Prefer 24-hour time? **System** → **My Profile** → **Edit Profile** → **Time Format**. The choice applies everywhere a time appears.

9. Autopilot — let Lumina plan your week

Autopilot is the hands-off option. Instead of building schedules yourself, Lumina builds a week of lighting for you — holidays, seasons, game nights, and quiet evenings in between.

On the **Schedule** tab, flip the **Autopilot** switch, then pick how much rope it gets:

Mode	What happens
Suggest	Lumina proposes changes and waits for you to tap Apply
Proactive	Lumina builds and applies the plan itself

- **Generate this week** builds a plan you can review day by day.
- **Lumina Suggestions** proposes individual ideas — tap **Apply** to accept, or **Show fewer** if you'd rather not be asked.
- Tap any day in the week strip to see or change what's planned.

Everything Autopilot creates is a normal schedule. Edit or delete any of it, any time.

10. Game Day and Sports Alerts

Game Day

Home → **Game Day**.

1. Tap **Add a Team**, pick a sport (Football, Basketball, Baseball), and search for your team.
2. Choose the design you want that team to use, or let Lumina build it from the team's colors.
3. Tap **Light Up Now** any time you want team colors immediately — tailgates, draft parties, watch nights.

Turn on **Autopilot** for a team and game days handle themselves. Options include:

- **Lead time before game** — how early the lights kick in
- **Skip day games** — don't bother when the game is fully in daylight
- **Design variety** — rotate through team designs, or use the same one every game
- **Motion style** — from subtle to **Fast Motion**
- **Refresh Schedule** — pull the latest game times

Game Day crews let you share the moment: create a crew, share the invite code, and neighbors' lights celebrate with yours.

Sports Alerts

System → **Sports Alerts** makes your lights react to live scoring.

1. Tap **Add Team**.
2. Set **Alert Sensitivity**:
 - **All Events** — flash on every scoring play
 - **Major Only** — touchdowns, goals, and home runs
 - **Clutch Only** — close, late-game moments only
3. Tap **Test Alert** to see it once without waiting for a game.

Touchdowns get a big light show, field goals a smaller one, and your lights return to whatever was playing afterward.

Score celebrations run while the Lumina app is open on your phone. Keep the app up during the game — the screen can be off.

11. Neighborhood Sync — light up the whole street

Neighborhood Sync lets several homes run one continuous animation, so a wave of color travels down the block instead of each house doing its own thing.

Home → Neighborhood Sync.

Starting a crew

1. Tap **Start a Block Party**.
2. Give your crew a name.
3. Choose whether it's a **Public Group** — public groups can be found by nearby neighbors looking to join.
4. Share the **invite code** by text or social media.

Joining a crew

Tap **Join the Party** and enter the code a neighbor gave you. Or tap **Discover Nearby Crews** to find public groups near you.

Setting up your house

Each home tells the crew two things:

- **Your LED count** — how many pixels your system has
- **Your position on the street** — so the animation flows in the right order

The host can drag homes into order under **Homes in Sync Order**. Different systems and different LED counts all work together — Lumina scales the animation to each house.

Running a show

Pick a pattern and start the sync. Every home in the crew picks it up and plays its slice.

Everyone in the crew should have the Lumina app open on their phone while a sync show runs — that's how each house receives the cue. Whole-crew automation that works with the app closed is coming in an update.

Managing a crew

- **Share Invite Code / Regenerate invite code** (invalidates the old one)

- **Leave Group** — rejoin any time with the code
- **Transfer Ownership** — hand the host role to another neighbor
- **Dissolve Crew** — remove the group entirely

12. Controlling your lights away from home

On your home Wi-Fi the app talks straight to your controller. Away from home it routes through the cloud — and you turn that on once.

System → System Management → Remote Access.

Step 1 — Save your home network

While you're at home and on your home Wi-Fi, tap **Detect Home Network**. This is how the app knows when to use the fast local path and when to go through the cloud.

Reading your Wi-Fi network name requires location permission on both iPhone and Android. If you're asked, allow it — the app uses it only for this, and your network name is encrypted before it's stored.

Step 2 — Pick a connection mode

ESP32 Bridge (recommended). A small Nex-Gen bridge stays plugged in at your house. Your commands go to the cloud, the bridge picks them up, and passes them to your lights on your home network.

- No port forwarding, no router changes
- Works with any internet provider
- Usually installed and paired by your installer

Tap **Test Bridge** to confirm. You want **Bridge Connected**.

Webhook (advanced / DIY). Routes commands to a web address pointing back at your house. Requires Dynamic DNS and port forwarding on your router. The app includes a step-by-step **Setup Guide** if you go this route.

Step 3 — Turn it on

Flip **Enable Remote Access**. The status card then tells you exactly where you stand:

Status	Meaning
On Home Network	Direct local control. Fastest.
Remote Mode Active	Commands are going through the cloud relay.
Away from Home	You're off your network and remote access isn't enabled yet.

Offline

No internet connection on your phone.

Remote commands take a few seconds longer than local ones — usually 5–10 seconds. That's the normal round trip through the cloud. Give it a moment before tapping again.

13. Sharing access with your household

Everyone in the house can have their own login — no shared passwords.

System → Manage Users.

1. Tap **Invite Family Member**.
2. Enter their email address and tap **Send Invite**.
3. The app shows a **6-character code**. Send it to them — it expires in **7 days**.

On their phone:

1. Download Lumina and create an account (or sign in).
2. Tap **Join with Code**.
3. Enter the 6-character code.
4. They're in — same lights, same designs, their own login and their own conversation with Lumina.

To remove someone, tap their name and choose **Remove Access**. Pending invitations can be revoked before they're used.

Everyone you invite gets full control of the lights. Per-person permission levels (view-only, kids' access) are on the roadmap. Today, invite the people you'd hand the remote to.

14. Voice assistants

System → **Voice Assistants** walks you through hands-free control.

Siri (iPhone)

Built in — no account linking needed.

1. Save the looks you use most as scenes.
2. On the Voice Assistants screen, tap **Add to Siri** next to a scene.
3. Record a short phrase — *"Movie time"*, *"Game day"*, *"Lights off."*
4. Say it any time: **"Hey Siri, game day."**

Short, memorable phrases work best.

Google Home and Amazon Alexa

The app includes guided setup for both, linking your Lumina account to the assistant so you can say things like **"Alexa, turn on the house lights."**

1. Open the Google Home or Alexa app.
2. Add / enable **Nex-Gen Lumina**.
3. Sign in with your Lumina account to link it.
4. Ask the assistant to discover devices.

Google Home and Alexa linking is still rolling out. If it isn't live for your account yet, Siri Shortcuts (iPhone) and the app itself cover everything in the meantime — check with your dealer for current availability.

Home Assistant (advanced)

Already running Home Assistant on a Raspberry Pi, NAS, or always-on computer? The app has an integration guide for native light-entity control and custom automations.

15. Personal touches

Your home photo

System → **My Profile** → **Edit Profile**. Add or replace the photo of your house — this is the picture the app animates your lights on.

My Whites

System → **My Whites**. Not everyone likes the same white. Pick your **Primary White** — the warm-to-cool tone you consider "your" white — and optionally a **Complement White** to keep on hand. Tap a swatch to preview it live on your lights, then save. Every warm-white request in the app then uses your preference. You can also build and name a custom white.

Your lights have a dedicated white channel, so whites come out clean and true rather than mixed from colors. It's worth spending two minutes here.

Welcome Home

System → **Geofence Controls**. Have your lights greet you when you pull in.

1. Set the **Trigger Distance** slider — anywhere from about 330 ft to 3,300 ft. Around 1,000 ft suits most homes.
2. Choose an action: **Turn On Warm White**, **Start Party Mode**, **Relax**, or **Turn Off**.
3. Decide whether it should fire **Only at Night**.
4. Save.

Requires location permission. Too small a radius and the lights may not beat you to the driveway; too large and they'll come on before you're close.

Simple Mode

System → **Simple Mode**. A stripped-down interface: large buttons, just Home and Settings, your favorites, and brightness. Great for a shared tablet, a guest, or anyone who wants three taps instead of thirty. Switch back any time.

Multiple properties

System → **My Properties**. Second home, cabin, or rental with Lumina? Add it here, link its controllers, and mark one as **PRIMARY** — that's the one that loads when you open the app. Switch between them without

signing out.

Refer & Earn

System → Refer a Friend. Share your code by text; when a referral installs, you earn a reward. Track referrals and rewards on the same screen.

16. System settings — what to touch, what to leave alone

System → **System Management** is home base for your hardware.

Safe to use any time

- **Controllers** — every controller, its name, IP address, and whether it's online. Tap one for details, set it active, or remove it if it's been replaced.
- **My Lights** (Lighting Areas) — your zones as your installer configured them.
- **Remote Access** — Section 12.
- **Roofline Setup** — review the layout of your peaks and runs; powers the Design Studio preview.

Installer territory

Hardware Configuration sets LED counts per channel, LED type (WS2812B RGB, SK6812 RGBW, TM1814 RGBW), and power supply limits. These were dialed in at install.

Changing LED counts or LED type can leave sections dark or show wrong colors. If something looks off, call your installer before changing anything here. These settings can only be changed on your home Wi-Fi — the app blocks them remotely on purpose.

Advanced Effects

Extra effect categories for specialized hardware (LED matrix installations, audio-reactive hardware). Leave off unless your installer says otherwise.

17. Troubleshooting

The lights won't respond

1. Check the controller has power — look for the green LED on the unit.
2. Confirm your phone is on your **home Wi-Fi**, not cellular or a guest network.
3. Look at the **router icon** at the top of the Home screen. Grey means the app can't reach the controller.
4. Pull down to refresh, or tap **Retry** on the orange banner.
5. Unplug the controller for **10 seconds**, plug it back in, and give it a minute to rejoin Wi-Fi.
6. Still nothing? Restart your router, then the controller.

"We can't find your lights — check your WiFi connection"

Either no controller is registered to your account, or none is reachable.

- Tap **Retry** first — often it's just a slow network moment.
- Brand-new system that was never registered? Tap **Set Up Controller**.
- Been working and suddenly stopped? Your controller likely dropped off Wi-Fi. Reboot it (unplug 10 seconds). If your Wi-Fi password changed recently, the controller needs to be reconnected — see the FAQ, or call your installer.

The app says "Last Known State"

The app is showing the last thing it heard from the controller because it can't reach it right now. Your lights may well be running fine. Check your Wi-Fi, or enable **Remote Access** if you're away from home.

A schedule didn't run

This is almost always the controller's clock. The Schedule tab shows a banner with a **How to fix** button when it detects a problem. Three causes:

1. The controller's clock was never set. Nothing fires at all.

Open the controller in a web browser by typing its IP address (find it in **System** → **System Management** → **Controllers**). Go to **Config** → **WiFi Setup** and confirm it's connected to your network. Then **Config** → **Time & Macros** and enable "**Get time from NTP server.**" The clock syncs within a minute once the controller has internet.

2. The time zone is wrong. Schedules fire, but at the wrong hour.

In the controller's web page: **Config** → **Time & Macros**, set **Time Zone** to your local zone, save, and reboot if prompted.

3. The schedule never reached the controller. Open the Schedule tab on your home Wi-Fi and tap **Sync**. You want **Schedules synced to controller**.

Also check: is the schedule **enabled**, and are the right **Repeat Days** selected?

The lights turned off on their own

A schedule's **off** time did its job. Schedules win over manual changes — deliberately, so your lights never stay on all night by accident. The app warns you when it's coming: *"Heads up — your 'Warm White' schedule turns the lights off at 11:00 PM."*

To keep a look past that point, edit the schedule's off time or switch that schedule off for the night.

My design changed back to something else

Something scheduled took over — a recurring schedule, an Autopilot event, or a Game Day event. Check the **TONIGHT / TODAY** card on the Home screen and the Schedule tab to see what's queued.

Only part of the house is lit

You have a zone filter, or a zone powered off.

1. Open **Adjust Pattern** (the tune icon).
2. Open the channel bar.
3. Tap **All Channels On**.

That re-selects every zone and powers each one on.

Colors look wrong

If reds and greens are swapped or whites look tinted, the controller's **color order** may not match your strip.

Open the controller in a browser and set **Color Order** to **RGB** — the Lumina default, and the fix for most color-accuracy issues.

If your whites look orange or washed out, mention it to your installer — there's a gamma setting on the controller that may need to be reasserted.

Remote control isn't working

1. **System** → **Remote Access** — is **Enable Remote Access** on?

2. Is your **Home Network** saved? Tap **Detect Home Network** next time you're home.
3. Bridge mode: tap **Test Bridge**. You want **Bridge Connected**. **Bridge Not Responding** means the bridge is unplugged or your home internet is down.
4. Remote commands take 5–10 seconds. Give it a moment.
5. Webhook mode: confirm your Dynamic DNS address is current and your router's port forward still points at the controller.

A pattern won't apply

- **"No controller connected"** — you're not reaching your lights. See the first entry above.
- **"Failed to apply pattern"** — usually a momentary network hiccup. Try again.
- If only one design misbehaves, try another to confirm, then tell support which one.

A pattern doesn't look how you expected

- Check your **brightness** — dim settings mute colors.
- Confirm you applied it to the **zone you intended** (no leftover FILTERED badge).
- Some effects are built for longer runs and read differently on short ones.

Everything is slow or the app feels stuck

Force-close the app and reopen it. If the controller was recently unplugged, give it a full minute to rejoin Wi-Fi before expecting a connection.

Sending diagnostics to Nex-Gen

System → **Support & Resources** → **Upload system logs**. This sends controller diagnostics to the Nex-Gen team. Do it before you call if you can — it makes the call much shorter.

18. Frequently asked questions

Getting started

Do I need Wi-Fi for my lights to work?

Your lights run their schedule from the controller itself, so they keep turning on and off on time even if your internet goes down. You need Wi-Fi to *change* anything from the app.

Does my phone have to stay on for my schedule to run?

No. Once a schedule syncs to the controller it runs on its own. Your phone can be off, away, or dead.

Can more than one person control the lights?

Yes — invite them under **System** → **Manage Users**. Each person gets their own login. Section 13.

I got a new phone. What do I do?

Install Lumina and sign in with the same email and password. Designs, favorites, and schedules all come with your account.

Can I use the app on a tablet?

Yes, same login. **Simple Mode** is a nice fit for a wall-mounted tablet.

I forgot my password.

Tap **Forgot Password?** on the sign-in screen, enter your email, and follow the reset link. To change a password you still know: **System** → **My Profile** → **Security**.

Everyday use

How do I light only the front of my house?

Open **Adjust Pattern** → **channel bar**, then tap the power icon on the zones you want off — or select just the front zone and apply a design to it. Section 4.

Can I have different colors on different parts of the house?

Yes. Select one zone, apply a design, then select another zone and apply a different one. Each zone keeps what you gave it.

What's the difference between My Favorites and My Designs?

My Designs is everything you've created or saved. **My Favorites** is your shortlist of go-to looks, shown right on the Home screen.

Why does the design name have a little bookmark icon?

You've adjusted something and it isn't saved. Tap the name to save your version to My Designs.

Do I have to use the app every night?

No — that's what schedules and Autopilot are for. Most homeowners set a schedule in the first week and open the app only when they want something special.

Schedules

How many schedules can I have?

Up to **20** recurring schedules.

Can my lights follow sunset instead of a clock time?

Yes. Choose **Sunset** as your on-time and **Sunrise** as your off-time, and your lights track the real sky all year — no retiming as the seasons shift. Your installer set your home's coordinates during the install, which is how Lumina knows when dusk falls at your address.

Two limits worth knowing: you can have **one sunrise schedule and one sunset schedule** (any others use clock times), and **offsets aren't available yet** — a sunset schedule fires at sunset, not "20 minutes before." If Lumina says it couldn't set a sunset schedule, your controller's location may not be set; your installer can fix that in a minute.

Why did my schedule save but not sync?

Writing schedules into the controller only works on your home Wi-Fi. It syncs automatically next time you open the Schedule tab at home, or tap **Sync**.

Two schedules overlap. Which one wins?

Whichever event fires last. Overlapping schedules make lighting unpredictable, which is why the app shows an orange banner with a **Clean Up** tool.

Can I skip one night without deleting my schedule?

Yes — switch the schedule off, or just apply what you want manually. Remember the schedule's off time still fires; the app warns you when that's coming.

Designs and features

Can I create a look that isn't in the library?

Two ways: describe it to **Lumina**, or build it in **Design Studio** where you place the colors yourself.

Are my team's colors included?

Pro and major college teams are in the **Game Day Fan Zone**. Don't see your team — a local high school, say? Ask Lumina and it can build the colors for you.

What does Neighborhood Sync actually do?

It makes several homes run one continuous animation so color flows down the street, each home playing its own slice in order. Section 11.

Do my neighbors need the same lights as me?

No. Different LED counts and different systems all work — each home reports its pixel count and Lumina scales the animation.

Will Sports Alerts flash while I'm out?

Score celebrations play while the Lumina app is open on your phone, so keep the app up during the game.

Hardware

Can I cut the light strips?

Yes, at the copper pads marked with cut lines — with the power off first. If you're extending or reconfiguring a run, call your installer; the LED counts in the app need to match the hardware.

How do I reconnect the controller after changing my Wi-Fi password?

The controller needs the new credentials. If you're comfortable doing it yourself: connect to the controller's own Wi-Fi access point (named **Lumina-XXXX**) and update its Wi-Fi settings. Otherwise your installer can do it in a couple of minutes.

Should I change anything in Hardware Configuration?

No — those values were dialed in at install, and wrong ones cause dark sections and bad colors. Call your installer first.

Do the lights use much electricity?

Very little. Modern pixel LEDs draw a fraction of traditional holiday lighting, and brightness is the biggest factor — running at 60% instead of 100% cuts consumption noticeably and usually looks better from the street anyway.

Will my lights survive winter?

Yes. The system is rated for permanent outdoor installation — rain, snow, and heat.

Privacy and account

Why does the app want my location?

Two features use it: **Welcome Home** (lights on when you arrive) and detecting your home Wi-Fi network name for remote access. Both are optional, and your location stays on your phone.

Can Nex-Gen see or control my lights?

Support sees only the diagnostics you choose to send with **Upload system logs**. Your installer can view your system to help troubleshoot, and that access is logged.

19. Quick reference — where do I find...?

I want to...	Go to
Turn lights on/off	Home → power circle
Change brightness	Home → brightness slider
Light only part of the house	Home → tune icon → channel bar
Get everything back on	Channel bar → All Channels On
Pick a holiday or team look	Explore
Create something new	Home → Design Studio
Save the current look	Tap the design name, or Save As Custom Pattern
Ask for a look in plain English	Lumina (center button)
Set on/off times	Schedule → +
Push schedules to the controller	Schedule → Sync
Let Lumina plan the week	Schedule → Autopilot
Set up a team	Home → Game Day
Score-based light shows	System → Sports Alerts
Sync with neighbors	Home → Neighborhood Sync
Control lights while away	System → Remote Access
Add a family member	System → Manage Users
Set up Siri / Alexa / Google	System → Voice Assistants
Add your house photo	System → My Profile → Edit Profile
Choose your white	System → My Whites
Lights on when I get home	System → Geofence Controls
Switch to 24-hour time	System → My Profile → Edit Profile
Simplify the app	System → Simple Mode

See my controllers	System → System Management → Controllers
Request a landscape design	System → Lumina Studio
Share your referral code	System → Refer a Friend
Send diagnostics to support	System → Upload system logs
Replay the tour	System → Take the Tour

20. Getting help

In the app

System → Support & Resources

- **Contact Nex-Gen Support** — email us or submit a request without leaving the app
- **Troubleshooting & FAQ** — quick self-serve answers
- **Video Tutorials** — step-by-step walkthroughs
- **Upload system logs** — send diagnostics so support sees what your controller sees

Before you call

Having these ready turns a long call into a short one:

1. What are the lights doing (or not doing)?
2. Does it happen at home, away, or both?
3. Is the router icon at the top of the Home screen cyan or grey?
4. Have you uploaded system logs?

Your installer

For anything physical — a dark section, a damaged run, a controller that won't come back, LED counts after a change — your installing dealer is the fastest path. They know your house.

Enjoy your lights.

Nex-Gen LED LLC · Powered by Nex-Gen · July 2026